



What is Dolby Vision?

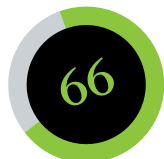
The recent advances in displays are nothing compared to Dolby Vision where they are building a brighter and better pixel <http://dgit.in/DolbyVision>



Candle-powered Speakers

Using thermoelectric effect, this bluetooth speaker can run on nothing but burning candles <http://dgit.in/CandleSpeakers>

Bazaar



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Specifications

Chipset: Intel Z97; **Memory support:** 4x3300(OC)MHz upto 32GB; **LAN:** Killer E2205 Gigabit Ethernet; **Audio:** ALC1150 7.1; **SATA:** 6x SATA III; **Expansion:** 2x PCIe X16(x16+x4); **Dimensions (LxWxD):** 305 mm x 244 mm; **Warranty:** 3 years

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MSI Z97 Gaming 3

The youngest in the Z97 Gaming series packs quite a punch

The board has support for 4 DDR3 RAM DIMMs which can be rated at 3300 MHz when overclocked. On a side-note, the H97 Gaming 3 only supports memory modules up to 1600 MHz which is sort of the optimal frequency when considering price-performance gains.

There are two PCIe x16 slots of which one runs at x16 and the other at x4. So what we end up losing is the ability to use two NVIDIA cards in SLI since NVIDIA mandates a minimum of 8 lanes per card. CrossFire is not a problem since AMD is more accommodating.

We see that this board has six SATA 6 GB/s ports of which two ports share bandwidth with the M.2 port.



Price
₹12,500
(+Tax)

There are 4 USB 3.0 ports on the back panel and 2 USB 2.0 ports. A header in the usual place near the motherboard ATX power connector allows for two more USB 3.0 ports. All the audio I/O ports seem to have gold plated contacts though the spec sheets mentions these to be oxygen-free copper.

The audio portion on this board has an isolated power supply but it's up to the user to make use of this feature. The Killer E2205 Ethernet chip which has become a staple on MSI's gaming motherboards makes an appearance on this board as well. The usual buffet of black solid state capacitors, high quality ferrite chokes, big heat sinks etc, does ensure that the baseline is at par with other manufacturers.

Mithun Mobandas

Sony Xperia M2 Dual

Too expensive to like, hit and a miss

This smartphone has a 4.8-inch TFT screen capacitive display, with the trademark Xperia glass finish on the front and back. The Xperia M2 Dual also has rubberised sides in order to provide better grip to the user. Overall, it is an ergonomically built and a nice looking smartphone.

If only that was enough though, since Sony has made some major blunders with this smartphone. To start with, the camera, which is usually the Japanese company's strong area, is way below par on this one. The 8MP shooter provides a lot of colour noise in the pictures even in proper light conditions.

Under low light conditions, the camera is even more disappointing. Considering the fact that many users buy Sony



Price
₹19,370

simply for its cameras, this is a major shortcoming. Add to that the fact that the front camera is of VGA quality and you do have to wonder how this device justifies its price tag.

Another hit and miss feature here is the sluggish UI on the Android 4.3 Jelly Bean OS. Now why would you do that, especially after pricing the phone at nearly ₹19k? We don't know, but we do know that at ₹5k lesser, the Moto G offers much better specs and value for money.

The redeeming thing about the Xperia M2 Dual though is that it has a long battery life. It can easily give you a full day under regular usage. People who want better-than-average battery life and good looks can still consider this one, although better alternatives exist.

Prasid Banerjee



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Performance65
Value70
Design65

Specifications

Operating System: Android 4.3 Jelly Bean; **Display:** 4.8 inch TFT with 540x960 pixel resolution; **Processor:** 1.2GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 400 quad-core processor; **Memory:** 8GB internal storage, 1GB RAM; **Camera:** 8MP rear with LED flash, VGA front; **Battery:** 2300mAh

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